The Riverside Plot

NEWSLETTER OF THE RIVERSIDE ALLOTMENT SOCIETY · ISSUE 37 · AUTUMN 2026

Record harvest at the autumn show

This year's autumn show drew 214 entries from 61 plot holders, the largest number since the society was founded in 1974. Judging took place on Saturday 19 September in the pavilion, with Ruth Penhaligon of the county horticultural guild as our guest judge. She praised the quality of the root vegetables and singled out the onions as the best she had seen this season.

The children's class was again a highlight. Eleven young growers showed decorated marrows, sunflower heads and miniature gardens laid out in seed trays.

"The best onions I have seen this season."

Water and the dry summer

The long dry spell in July tested everyone's patience and our water supply. The committee thanks all members who kept to the watering rota, which meant that no plot was left without water for more than two days. Two new rainwater tanks will be installed by the main gate before next spring.

Rents for 2027

At the general meeting members agreed to keep the annual rent at £38 for a full plot and £21 for a half plot. Rents are due by 1 February and can be paid at the trading hut on Sunday mornings.

Dates for your diary

- 1 November: bulb and seed swap at the trading hut, 10:00
- 15 November: working party on the boundary hedges
- 6 December: mince pies and plot photographs in the pavilion
- 7 February: general meeting at St Anne's church hall

Committee

Chair	Desmond Okafor
Secretary	Lin Parry
Treasurer	Gwen Tallis
Lettings	Ravi Mehta
Newsletter	Bea Lindqvist

From the plots

Plot 14: a first year without digging

When Joanna and Theo took over plot 14 last winter, it was knee-deep in couch grass. Instead of digging, they covered the ground with cardboard and a thick layer of compost. By June they were picking lettuce, and the beds have needed very little weeding since.

Plot 52: saving your own tomato seed

Harry Blunt has grown the same plum tomato for twenty-two years from his own seed. He scoops the seeds into a jar of water, leaves them to ferment for three days and then dries them on kitchen paper. Members can collect a free packet of his seed at the November swap.

Show results

Class	Winner	Plot
Longest runner bean	Aled Morgan	7
Heaviest onion	Priya Desai	33
Five potatoes, one variety	Tom Cardew	18
Jar of chutney	Mags Heron	41
Children's decorated marrow	Isla Ferreira (age 8)	22

Notices

- The trading hut now sells peat-free compost at £6.50 a bag.
- Please keep the main track clear for the delivery lorry on Thursday mornings.
  - Cars may park in the lay-by beside the gate instead.
- Lost: a green-handled pruning saw near plot 30, please return it to the hut.

Contributions for the winter issue are welcome until 20 December. Leave them in the box at the trading hut or send them to the newsletter editor.